



Paris. It could be argued that India had far more athletes in medal-winning positions in Paris. Leaving aside Vinesh Phogat's disqualification from the final — and an assured silver — in the women's 53kg wrestling category, eight Indian athletes finished fourth or were one win away from a medal in Paris, compared to four in Tokyo.

Conversely, Olympic success didn't translate to World Championship results. **None of India's Paris medallists won a medal in their respective 2025 World Championship events, including double Olympic medallist Manu Bhaker. But the rest of the shooting contingent more than made up for it by winning eight medals in Cairo, including first-ever medals in the men's 10m air pistol and 25m air pistol events.**

"There's no guarantee that World Championship results will translate into Olympic medals, especially in a sport like shooting. But the fact that there are so many medals being won with very little dependence on one or two athletes suggests that India's bench strength in shooting, in particular, is very healthy," says Pandit.

Ruthless: Antim Panghal beat Sweden's Malmgren 9-1 to win bronze at the 2025 Wrestling World Championships, becoming only the second Indian woman after Vinesh Phogat to win two World Championship medals. GETTY IMAGES

While shooting appears to be on solid ground, other sports are not on nearly as firm a footing. Wrestling and badminton's World Championship medals have come from athletes who had already won World Championship medals previously — bronze for Antim Panghal in women's freestyle 53kg and the pair of Chirag Shetty and Satwiksairaj Rankireddy in men's doubles. No other athlete in their respective sports came close this year. Boxing, too, has promised much in prior Olympic cycles, only for athletes to fall short in Paris. The national federation has already made significant changes, replacing national women's coach D Chandralal with former chief coach Santiago Nieva.

What will matter now is how athletes and federations build on these results and whether they

Indian results in Olympic events at World Championships in 2025



Shooting

Samrat Rana — Gold, Men's 10m Air Pistol

Varun Tomar — Bronze, Men's 10m Air Pistol

Esha Singh — Bronze, Women's 25m Pistol

Anish Bhanwala — Silver, Men's 25m Rapid Fire Pistol

Samrat Rana & Esha Singh — Silver, 10m Air Pistol Mixed Team

Zorawar Sandhu — Bronze, Men's Trap

Elavenil Valarivan — Bronze, Women's 10m Air Rifle

Aishwary Pratap Singh Tomar — Silver, Men's 50m Rifle 3 Positions

Archery

Jyothi Surekha Vennam & Rishabh Yadav — Silver, Compound Mixed Team

Badminton

Satwiksairaj Rankireddy & Chirag Shetty — Bronze, Men's Doubles

Wrestling

Antim Panghal — Bronze, Women's 53kg

Boxing

Jaismine Lamboria — Gold, Women's 57kg